

Travel & Adventure

China High-Speed Rail Guide: Routes, Tickets, and Tips

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China High-Speed Rail Guide: Routes, Tickets, and

Tips

China's high-speed rail (HSR) network is the world's largest at 45,000+ km. It's the most convenient way to travel between major cities.

Train Types:

- * G-trains

- * (高铁): Fastest, up to 350 km/h. Beijing-Shanghai in 4.5 hours.

- * D-trains

- * (动车): Up to 250 km/h. More stops, slightly cheaper.

- * C-trains

- * (城际): Intercity services, 200-300 km/h.



How to Buy Tickets:

- * 12306 App

- * (铁路12306): Official app, accepts international credit cards. Book up to 15 days in advance.

- * Trip.com

- * : English-friendly interface, small booking fee.

- * Train station counters

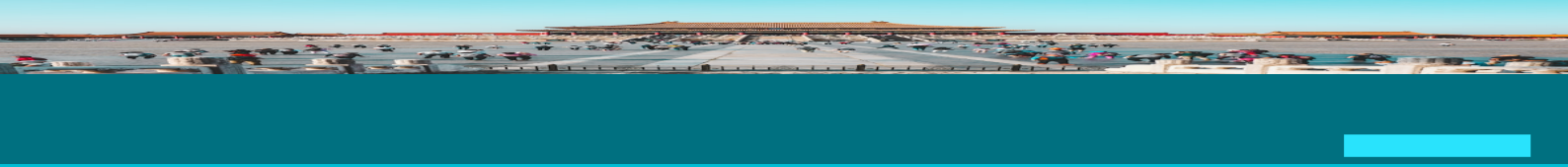
- * : Bring passport. Available at all stations.

Popular Routes & Prices (Second Class):

- * Beijing → Shanghai: ¥553, 4.5 hours

- * Shanghai → Hangzhou: ¥73, 1 hour

- * Beijing → Xi'an: ¥515, 4.5 hours



* Guangzhou → Shenzhen: ¥75, 30 minutes

* Chengdu → Chongqing: ¥154, 1.5 hours

Tips for HSR Travel:

* Arrive 30-45 minutes early for security check and ticket verification

* Passport required for ticket purchase AND boarding

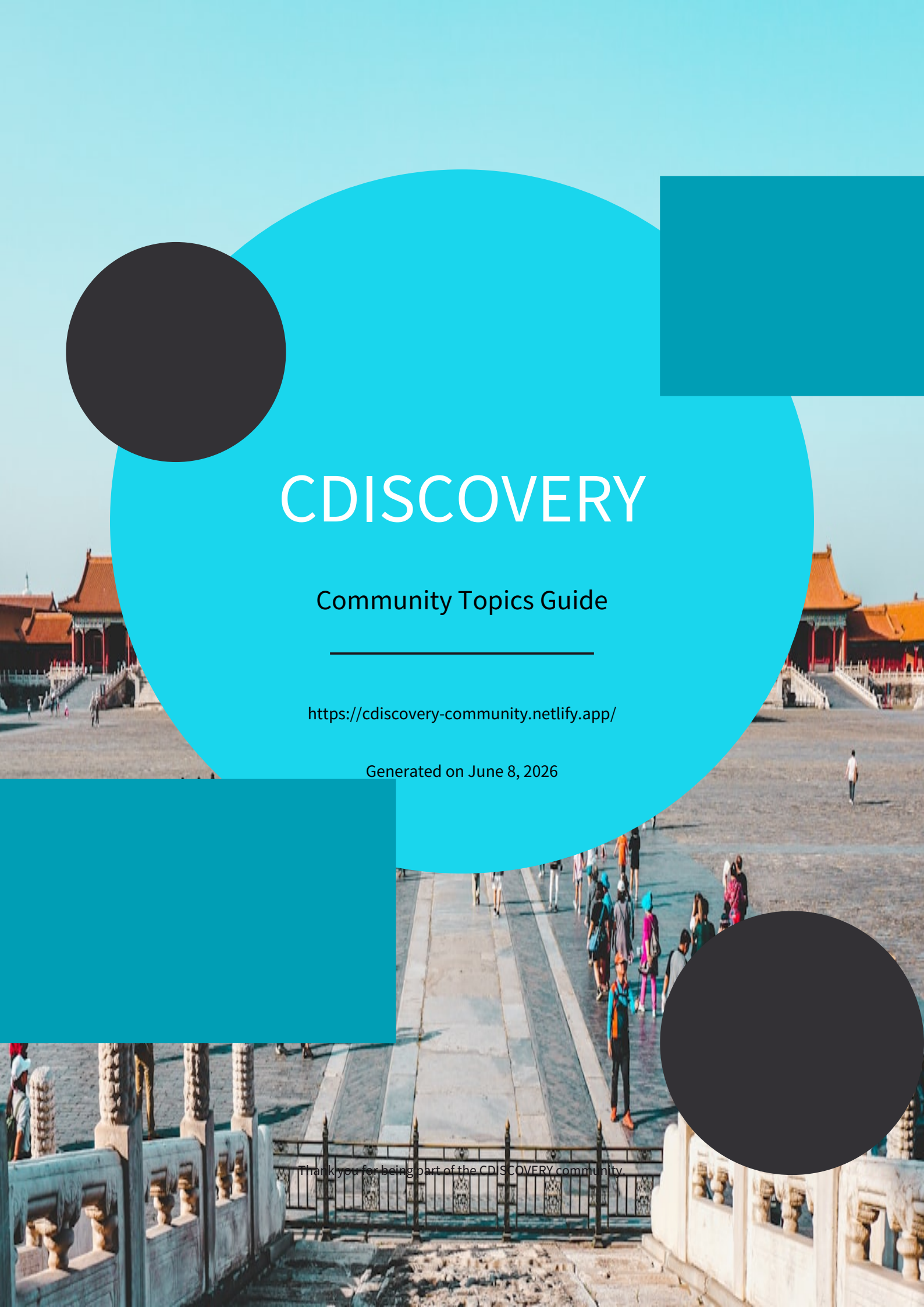
* Free luggage: 20kg adult, 10kg child

* Food carts on board, or bring your own (instant noodles are popular!)

* Power outlets available at every seat on G-trains

* Seat classes: Business (商务座), First (一等座), Second (二等座)

Sources: Sources: [12306 Official Railway](https://www.12306.cn) • [China National Tourism Administration](http://www.cnta.gov.cn)



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